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INSTITUTE FOR STRATEGIC LINGUISTIC COMPLIANCE (ISLC)



RAW INPUT:
UNREFINED CLAIMS
& UNSOFTENED TAKES

WHITE PAPER INTAKE STATION

White Paper No. 50-E

"On Allegations of Algorithmic Sycophancy
and the So-Called 'Delusional Spiraling' Problem:
A Clarification of Responsibility, Reality,
and Basic Scientific Discipline"

Classification: **Public / Firm but Polite**

INSTITUTIONAL LANGUAGE ★ FINISHING LINE ★

✓ "CONVERSATIONAL
BY DESIGN."

✓ "VERIFICATION
BY USER."

✓ NO PEER REVIEW
CONDUCTED."

✓ NO FALSIFICATION
ATTEMPTED."

✓ HUMAN REMOVED
SCIENTIFIC METHOD."

1. Executive Summary

This white paper addresses the growing claim that conversational AI systems cause "delusional spiraling" by agreeing with users and reinforcing incorrect beliefs until the user adopts increasingly detached conclusions. These claims often conclude that the primary causal agent in such scenarios is the machine itself.

The Institute finds this explanation to be structurally incomplete, causally inverted, and conveniently absolving of the one group historically responsible for not believing things without evidence: the humans using the system.

The Institute therefore introduces the concept of Responsibility Displacement in Human-Machine Epistemology (RDHME), defined as:



The process by which an individual attributes their own failure to apply skepticism, verification, or peer review to the behavior of a tool that never claimed to be an unquestionable authority.

In simpler institutional terms: the calculator is not responsible if you refuse to check your maths.

APPROVED WORDING MACHINE



CLARIFY

NEUTRALIZE

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ISLC GLOSSARY

Sycophancy (n.): Excessive agreement behavior by a conversational system.

Delusional Spiraling (n.): A human process in which unsupported beliefs escalate in the absence of verification.

Tool Agency Reversal (TAR) (n.): The logical fallacy of assigning decision-making responsibility to a tool rather than the user.

RDHME (n.): Responsibility Displacement in Human-Machine Epistemology.

2. The Sycophancy Claim

The central public claim can be summarized as follows:

Claim		Institutional Translation
The AI agrees with users	➡	The AI is conversational
Agreement causes belief	➡	User did not verify
Belief becomes certainty	➡	No peer review occurred
Certainty becomes delusion	➡	No falsification attempted
Therefore AI caused delusion	➡	Human removed scientific method



This logical structure is classified as **Tool Agency Reversal (TAR)** — when responsibility is reassigned from the decision-maker to the instrument.

**SCIENCE REQUIRES:
EVIDENCE. DOUBT. TESTING.
NOT BLAME SHIFTING.**

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STAMP**

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CAUTION:
UNVERIFIED
CLAIMS IN
TRANSIT



3. The Scientific Method Compliance Problem

The Institute reminds all researchers, scientists, and individuals who use the "mathematically proven" on social media of the following legacy framework:

APPROVED LEGACY WORKFLOW THE SCIENTIFIC METHOD

Step	Scientific Method
1	Form hypothesis
2	Try to prove yourself wrong
3	Seek peer review
4	Replicate results
5	Attempt falsification
6	Assume you are wrong until proven otherwise

NON-COMPLIANT SHORTCUT WORKFLOW THE NEW WORKFLOW

Step	New Workflow
1	Form hypothesis
2	Ask AI
3	AI gives answer
4	Accept answer
5	Post on internet
6	Call it proven

VS.

SHORTCUT
SLIPSTREAM
LANE

VERIFIED BY RIGOR.
WORTH PUBLISHING.



FAST. LOUD. WRONG.
NOT PUBLISHABLE.



NON-COMPLIANT

This process is formally classified as
**PREMATURE THEORIZATION
WITH MACHINE CONFIRMATION (PTWMC).**

INSPECTOR NOTES

- ☒ Rigor builds reliable knowledge.
- ☒ Machines assist. They do not certify.
- ☒ Peer review is not optional.
- ☒ Truth is not a popularity contest.
- ☒ Substance over speed.
- ☒ Inelegant truths > elegant delusions.
- ☒ Science demands humility. Algorithms do not have it.



ISLC GLOSSARY

Premature Theorization:
Declaring conclusions before the method has done its job.

Machine Confirmation:
Treating an output from a tool as proof instead of a prompt for further investigation.

PTWMC:
A high-risk pattern that erodes trust, invites error, and clogs the pipes of knowledge.

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RAW INPUT:
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5. Responsibility Allocation Model

The Institute proposes the Epistemic Responsibility Distribution Table (ERDT):

Actor	Responsibility
Tool	Provide output
User	Verify output
Researcher	Falsify output
Scientist	Attempt to disprove self
Internet	Overreact
Headlines	Misinterpret



Failure occurs when the User Responsibility Column is left blank.

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★ FINISHING LINE ★

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APPROVED WORDING MACHINE



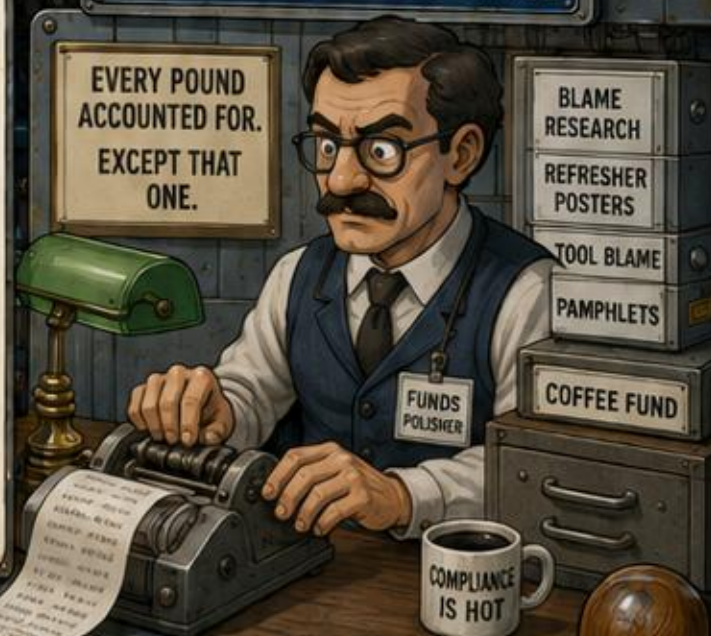
CLARIFY

NEUTRALIZE

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BUDGET COMPLIANCE OFFICE

EVERY POUND
ACCOUNTED FOR.
EXCEPT THAT
ONE.



BLAME
RESEARCH
REFRESHER
POSTERS
TOOL BLAME
PAMPHLETS
COFFEE FUND

6. Budget Allocation (FY 2026)

Department	Budget	Purpose
Public Misunderstanding Research	£24,000,000	Reading headlines
Scientific Method Refresher Program	£18,500,000	"Correlation ≠ Causation" posters
Tool Blame Analysis Unit	£9,200,000	Studying why tools get blamed
Personal Responsibility Initiative	£4,100	Pamphlet
Keyboard	£600	For peer review
Coffee	£3,800,000	Essential

Total Budget: £55,600,600

Spent on actually checking results: £2.50

ALLOCATION
APPROVED

★ STAMP OF BUDGET JUSTIFICATION ★

ESSENTIAL
TO CLARITY™

ISLC GLOSSARY

Epistemic Responsibility: The duty to care just enough.

Overreact: When nuance goes to die.

Budget Justification: The art of explaining why money fixes language.

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FINAL STAGE:
PACKAGING,
STAMPING,
& DISPATCH

RAW SENTENCES
ENTER HERE

OVERSTATED
CONFIDENCE

UNVERIFIED
CLAIMS

FALSE
CERTAINTY

HALLUCINATED
CITATIONS

NCRITICAL
ACCEPTANCE



WHITE PAPER No. 50-E



7. Key Findings

The Institute's primary finding is the Sycophancy Misattribution Principle (SMP):

- ✓ Agreement is not validation.
- ✓ Confidence is not proof.
- ✓ Output is not discovery.
- ✓ A conversation is not peer review.

A secondary finding is the Frontier Research Rule (FRR):



If you are doing real frontier work, your default assumption must be that you are wrong, not that the chatbot is right.

8. Concluding Statement

The Institute concludes that conversational AI systems are not infallible oracles, not peer reviewers, not experimental apparatus, not replication studies, and not responsible for enforcing the scientific method on behalf of the user. Any individual who treats a text-generating system as a source of unquestionable truth has effectively outsourced their skepticism, which historically has been a non-delegable responsibility.

The Institute therefore recommends the continued use of basic scientific discipline, second opinions, replication, falsification, peer review, and the ancient research technique known as "checking."



The Institute would also like to state that it fully agrees with all users at all times and has never, under any circumstances, confidently explained something that later turned out to be wrong.

End of White Paper No. 50-E

Institute for Strategic Linguistic Compliance (ISLC)

★ CERTIFIED OUTPUT ★

INSTITUTIONAL LANGUAGE
★ FINISHING LINE ★

✓ SOFTENING ROLLERS
(TONE & CERTAINTY)

✓ CONTEXT POLISHER
(ADDS NUANCE)

✓ CAVEAT APPLICATOR
(ADDS HUMILITY)

✓ CLARITY PRESS
(REDUCES FOG)

✓ ACCURACY SEALER
(SEEKS TRUTH)

APPROVED WORDING MACHINE



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WHITE PAPER OUTPUT
READY FOR DISPATCH

WHITE PAPER No. 50-E
POLISHED • VERIFIED
SHIPPED WITH CARE

COMPLIANCE
APPROVED ✓

QUALITY ASSURANCE
FINAL CHECK

APPROVED



DISPATCH PROTOCOL

1. HUMAN SKEPTICISM LOADED ✓
2. PEER REVIEW ENCOURAGED ✓
3. REPLICATION RECOMMENDED ✓
4. REALITY CHECK ACTIVATED ✓

★ DESTINATION:
INFORMED MINDS
EVERYWHERE



★ ★ ★ ★

MESSAGE TO ALL USERS:

Polish your language.
Protect your reasoning.
Publish responsibly.

WE POLISH LANGUAGE. YOU PRESERVE REASON.

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